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steering-committee.md - Proposed contents as a draft

Flatcar Steering Committee Charter

Status: DRAFT / PROPOSAL. This document is not yet adopted. Adopting it requires a vote of the Maintainers as described in governance.md.

This document describes what the Flatcar Steering Committee is for, what it does, and how it is run.

Mission

The Steering Committee is responsible for the non-technical side of the Flatcar project. It handles governance, community structure, project resources, and long-term direction.

The Steering Committee exists to serve the project and the community. It does not replace the Maintainer Council, which remains the main governing body of the project.

How it works

- The Committee can adapt its own role and structure as the project's needs change.
- Anything not explicitly delegated to another group stays with the Steering Committee.
- Technical decisions are delegated to the Technical Committee and the relevant maintainer subgroups.
- Day-to-day running of the project stays with the Maintainer Council and its subgroups.

What the Steering Committee does not do

The Steering Committee sets direction and policy. It does not micromanage the project.

In particular, the following should continue to happen through the normal maintainer and subgroup process, with no Steering Committee approval required:

- Creating, renaming, archiving, or transferring repositories in the `flatcar` GitHub organisation.
- Granting or adjusting normal project access for maintainers, contributors, and subgroups.
- Running CI, automation, bots, and tooling needed for normal project work.
- Running releases, triaging issues, reviewing pull requests, and other routine maintenance work.

The Steering Committee should only step in when a matter is project-wide, non-technical, or explicitly escalated to it.

Escalations

Escalations are used to resolve misalignments and are always agreed on by involved parties. *All parties* must at a minimum agree on the fact that a blocking problem *exists* that cannot be resolved between parties directly, and mediation of the steering committee is required.

Responsibilities

The Steering Committee is responsible for:

- Setting and defending the non-technical vision, mission, and values of the project.
- Defining and evolving the project's governance structure.
- Creating and approving charters for project-wide groups such as committees, working groups, and subgroups.
- Acting as the final escalation point for non-technical disputes in the project (see Escalations above).
- Managing the project's relationship with the CNCF and other outside bodies.
- Advising on trademark, branding, advocacy, and other non-technical project matters.
- Holding and delegating authority over project-wide assets such as GitHub organisation ownership, websites, domains, mailing lists, social-media accounts, and similar resources.
- Defining what it means for a project group to be in good standing and enforcing those expectations.

Working with the Technical Committee

Technical direction, architecture, and cross-cutting engineering decisions are handled by the Technical Committee.

The Steering Committee does not overrule technical decisions. When a matter has both technical and non-technical aspects, the Steering Committee and Technical Committee are expected to work together, each deciding the parts that fall under their own remit.

Membership

Size

The Steering Committee has X seats.

Seat types

The Steering Committee may include one or more categories of seats, such as:

- Contributor seats: held by people selected based on project contribution.
- Community seats: held by people selected to represent the broader community.
- Other seat categories as the project may choose to define.

The exact number and type of seats is X.

Eligibility

Eligibility to stand for the Steering Committee is X.

Eligibility to vote in Steering Committee elections is X.

Terms

Members serve X-year terms.

A member may serve for at most X consecutive terms / X consecutive years.

After reaching that limit, a member must step off the Committee for X before serving again.

Terms may be staggered so that X seats are up each cycle, or all seats may be elected together. The exact approach is X.

Company representation

The project may choose to limit the number of seats held by people from the same company.

The exact company representation rule is X.

If the project adopts a same-company limit, the process for handling election results or mid-term employer changes that break that limit is X.

Vacancies

If a member leaves before the end of their term, the vacancy is filled by X.

Removal

A Steering Committee member may be removed by X.

The process for initiating and recording such a removal is X.

Emeritus

The project may choose to recognise former Steering Committee members as Emeritus.

The meaning and privileges of Emeritus status are X.

Voting

The Steering Committee should aim to work by consensus whenever possible.

When a vote is needed:

- A normal decision passes with X.
- A charter change passes with X.
- Other special thresholds are X.

The exact voting process, including where votes happen and how long they stay open, is X.

Meetings

The Steering Committee meets X.

Meetings may be open, closed, or a mix of both. The expected meeting model is X.

The quorum for holding a meeting is X.

The quorum or threshold for taking a vote during a meeting is X.

The Steering Committee and Technical Committee may hold regular joint sessions. If so, the frequency and expectations for those sessions are X.

Changes to this charter

Changes to this charter are approved by X.

The exact process for proposing, discussing, voting on, and merging charter changes is X.

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steering-elections.md - Proposed contents as a draft

Flatcar Steering Committee Elections

Status: DRAFT / PROPOSAL. This document is not yet adopted. Adopting it requires a vote of the Maintainers as described in governance.md.

This document describes how Steering Committee elections work.

Purpose

The election process should produce a Steering Committee that is trusted by the project, reflects the community, and is able to carry out the responsibilities described in the Steering Committee charter.

Open design questions

The project still needs to decide the following:

- How many total seats there should be: X
- Whether there should be different seat types: X
- If there are different seat types, how many seats of each type: X
- Who can stand for election: X
- Who can vote: X
- How long terms should be: X
- Whether terms should be staggered: X
- Whether there should be term limits: X
- Whether there should be company representation limits: X
- What voting system should be used: X
- How vacancies should be filled: X

Candidate eligibility

Candidate eligibility is X.

If the project wants different eligibility rules for different seat types, those rules are X.

Voter eligibility

Voter eligibility is X.

If the project wants to recognise non-code contributions, the process for doing so is X.

Seat allocation

The Steering Committee seat allocation model is X.

Possible models include:

- All seats elected the same way.
- Some seats allocated by contribution and others elected by the community.
- Some seats reserved for specific groups or perspectives.
- Some other model.

The chosen model is X.

Election method

The election method is X.

Possible methods include Condorcet, approval voting, ranked choice, simple majority, or another system.

The chosen method is X.

Company representation

If the project adopts limits on same-company representation, the exact rules are X.

If the project adopts separate seat categories, the rules for how same-company limits apply across those categories are X.

Election operations

The election is run by X.

The nomination period is X.

The voting period is X.

The method for publishing results is X.

Any recusal, campaigning, or election-officer rules are X.

Vacancies and replacements

If an elected member cannot serve or leaves early, the replacement process is X.

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technical-committee.md - Proposed contents as a draft

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Flatcar Technical Committee Charter

Status: DRAFT / PROPOSAL. This document is not yet adopted. Adopting it requires a vote of the Maintainers as described in governance.md.

This document describes what the Flatcar Technical Committee is for, what it does, and how it is run.

Mission

The Technical Committee is responsible for the technical health, architecture, and overall engineering direction of Flatcar.

It provides technical leadership, helps resolve disputes that span multiple repositories or subgroups, and maintains technical standards across the project.

The maintainer subgroups continue to own and run their own areas day to day. The Technical Committee exists to coordinate across those areas and decide matters that no single subgroup should own alone.

Scope

The Technical Committee handles technical matters that affect the project as a whole rather than a single repository or subgroup.

Responsibilities

The Technical Committee is responsible for:

- Setting and defending the technical direction and architecture of the project.
- Owning and maintaining the process for technical proposals, design reviews, architectural decisions, or similar project-wide technical processes.
- Defining project-wide technical standards and conventions.
- Resolving technical disputes or escalations that cannot be resolved within a single subgroup (see Escalations above).
- Coordinating technical direction across repositories, subgroups, and cross-cutting initiatives.
- Advising the Steering Committee on technical implications of non-technical decisions.

What the Technical Committee does not do

The Technical Committee sets technical direction. It should not sit in the path of routine engineering work.

In particular, the following should remain with the normal maintainer and subgroup process, with no Technical Committee approval required:

- Ordinary review and merge decisions in a single area.
- Creating, renaming, archiving, or transferring repositories.
- Setting up CI, bots, tooling, and normal engineering automation.
- Routine package additions, bug fixes, refactors, and other ordinary technical work that already has an established owner or process.

The Technical Committee should only step in when a matter is cross-cutting, project-wide, architectural, or explicitly escalated.

Relationship to other bodies

Maintainer Council

The Technical Committee operates within the authority delegated by the Maintainer Council and the project's governance.

Maintainer subgroups

Maintainer subgroups continue to own their own areas. The Technical Committee coordinates across them and resolves cross-area technical questions.

Steering Committee

The Steering Committee handles non-technical governance. The Technical Committee handles technical governance. When a matter has both technical and non-technical aspects, the two committees should work together.

Membership

Size

The Technical Committee has X seats.

Eligibility

Eligibility to stand for the Technical Committee is X.

Eligibility to vote in Technical Committee elections or selections is X.

Selection model

Technical Committee members are chosen by X.

Possible models could include election, appointment, nomination plus vote, or some other mechanism. The chosen model is X.

Terms

Members serve X-year terms.

A member may serve for at most X consecutive terms / X consecutive years.

After reaching that limit, a member must step off the Committee for X before serving again.

Terms may be staggered so that X seats are up each cycle, or all seats may be selected together. The exact approach is X.

Company representation

The project may choose to limit the number of seats held by people from the same company.

The exact company representation rule for the Technical Committee is X.

Vacancies

If a member leaves before the end of their term, the vacancy is filled by X.

Removal

A Technical Committee member may be removed by X.

The process for initiating and recording such a removal is X.

Emeritus

The project may choose to recognise former Technical Committee members as Emeritus.

The meaning and privileges of Emeritus status are X.

Decision-making

The Technical Committee should aim to work by consensus whenever possible.

When a vote is needed:

- A normal technical decision passes with X.
- A major architectural or breaking decision passes with X.
- Other special thresholds are X.

The exact voting process, including where votes happen and how long they stay open, is X.

Meetings

The Technical Committee meets X.

Meetings may be open, closed, or a mix of both. The expected meeting model is X.

The quorum for holding a meeting is X.

The quorum or threshold for taking a vote during a meeting is X.

The Steering Committee and Technical Committee may hold regular joint sessions. If so, the frequency and expectations for those sessions are X.

Changes to this charter

Changes to this charter are approved by X.

The exact process for proposing, discussing, voting on, and merging charter changes is X.